

SKOAR! Special

GOD OF WAR 3

Genre: Action, Beat 'em Up

Studio: Monolith Studio

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Platforms: PlayStation 3

Price: Rs 2,499

THE SKOAR

8.5

GOD OF WAR III

PROS:

- Technically the game works better than most games on the PlayStation 3
- Has grander version of everything you would expect from a game in this series
- Respectable replay value for a game in its genre

CONS:

- Unlike the series debut, the conclusion does not offer anything significantly fresh
- Can be perceived as a bit too violent and even depressing

Crazy Kratos returns

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In the third and supposedly the final chapter, Kratos is a vengeful spirit with the single objective of destroying Mount Olympus and killing the king of Gods, Zeus. As one would imagine, the ensuing battle is spectacular, both in its scale and the destruction it causes. Just like God of War II, this game starts off with an epic battle and by the end of it Kratos is stripped of his powers and weapons. The central objective from this point is to recover the Flames of Olympus that are said to have the power to kill a God. Standing between Kratos and the Flames is a whole bevy of Olympian Gods and their minions.

God of War III is one of the most violent and gruesome games I have played since Manhunt. Even the violence depicted in the first two games pales in comparison to what you will experience in this game.

Accompanying Kratos in his bloody crusade is his trusty pair of Blades of Athena, now re-christened Blades of the Exile. Augmenting his destructive abilities are three other weapons and all four weapons also have magic abilities

attached to them. Familiar collectibles like the Gorgon Eyes and Phoenix Features make a return and once again they can be offered as sacrifice to increase Kratos's health, magic and item-power pool. Kratos can also recover other relics of Gods throughout the game; however these can only be used during subsequent play-through. These items give the player incredible bonuses and essentially they work like cheat codes.

The developers have added things to the series even though they maybe few and far in between. For instance, some of the QTE-based finishing moves are viewed from a first-person perspective. For most part, this game retains core-mechanics from the first two games. Kratos's primary blade has the familiar combos and all other weapons have similar keystrokes and effect. If things get really hairy, you can unleash magic contained within the weapons for some effective crowd control. Outside of combat it still about platforming, shifting pillars, smashing objects and pulling switches and chains to unlock the way forward.

It took me about seven hours to beat God of War III on normal difficulty setting. After beating the

game – true to God of War tradition – there is plenty of bonus content. The game unlocks bonus costume, the highest difficulty level, a challenge mode and lots of developer videos. All of the game's cinematic also become available in the video gallery. While you can pretty much get away with mindless button mashing throughout the game, the Challenge mode will require some skills to beat. After beating the Challenge Mode, the game unlocks the Combat Arena. We are not sure about the nature of this Combat Arena, but speculations on some of discussion boards indicate that this is where you can design your own challenges. Design to the extent that before the start of combat, the player will get to decide the type of enemy they will fight.

If you are expecting all that was God of War on PS2, but only at a much grander scale then you probably should not wait to get your copy of the game. The developers seem have been very careful about not messing too much with the game's core-mechanics, as new features are introduced only in small doses. God of War III is quite simply a relentless and epic bloodbath from the start, right till the credits start rolling. **d**